GRADE 10 / Mathematical Literacy / English

A budget that balances

01 Understand

Learning goals: Distinguish income from expenditure • Calculate a budget balance • Explain a realistic spending adjustment

A budget estimates money received and spent over the same period. Actual spending may differ from planned spending.

Fixed expenses are usually agreed amounts; variable expenses depend on use. A surplus is income minus expenses when the result is positive.

Compare like periods and units. Include transport, food and data before treating an apparent surplus as available savings.

One learner’s monthly plan

Item	Rand	Type
Income	1 200	income
Transport	400	expense
Food	350	expense
Data	150	expense
Other	100	expense

02 Follow the reasoning

Use the plan to calculate the balance and test whether saving R250 is feasible.

1. Expenses = 400 + 350 + 150 + 100 = R1 000.

2. Balance = R1 200 − R1 000 = R200.

3. Saving R250 needs another R50. Reduce an affordable expense or increase income; do not assume essential transport can disappear.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Income is R2 000 and expenses R1 750. Calculate the surplus.

2. Data spending rises from R150 to R180. Find the increase as a percentage.

3. A weekly expense is R50. Estimate its cost over a stated four-week month.

04 Check and correct

1. R250.

2. Increase R30; 30 ÷ 150 × 100 = 20%.

3. R200 for four weeks. A calendar month is not always exactly four weeks.

Common mistake to avoid

A surplus is a money amount. A percentage increase uses the original amount as its denominator.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Finance: income, expenditure and budgets

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Mathematical Literacy. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID matlit-10.